



FOCUSONFORCE

Releasing

Apply map sandbox strategy to a specific Release Plan taking into consideration multiple project streams, training requirements, staging, and hotfixes.

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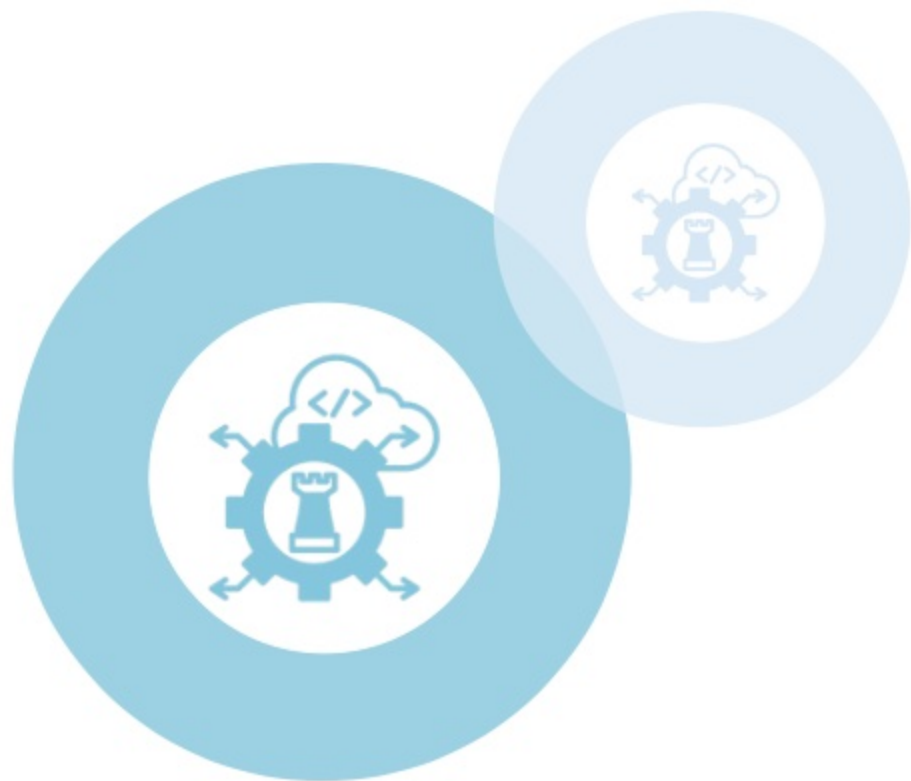
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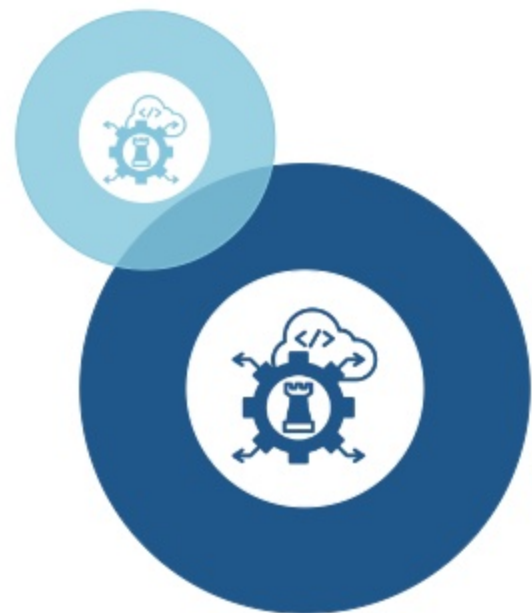
After studying this topic, you should be able to:

-  Describe the considerations for selecting a sandbox strategy for a specific release plan.
-  Recommend suitable sandbox strategies for the given business requirements while considering various aspects.



Introduction

In today's dynamic Salesforce development environment, aligning a sandbox strategy with a comprehensive release plan is essential for project success. This involves meticulous planning across **multiple project streams**, each with its distinct development and deployment timelines. A well-thought-out sandbox strategy ensures that various teams can work in parallel without interference, while also accommodating **training** needs for end-users on new features or updates. Additionally, having a dedicated environment for **staging** allows for thorough validation of features and updates before production deployment, ensuring that each release enhances the system's functionality and stability. Moreover, the strategy must include provisions for **urgent hotfixes** to address any unforeseen issues promptly.



Sandbox Strategies

Multiple Project Streams

Developer or Developer Pro sandboxes can be assigned to each project team when there are multiple project streams.

Training Requirements

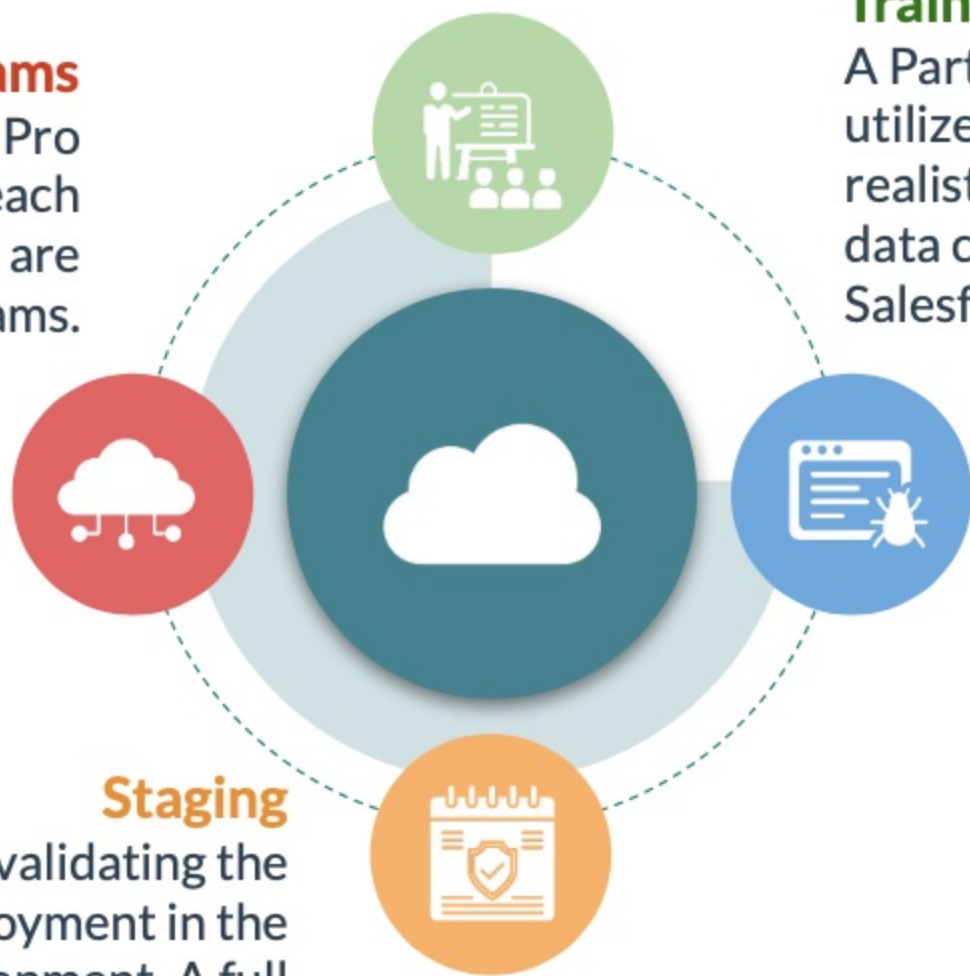
A Partial Copy or Full sandbox can be utilized for facilitating training using realistic datasets. If required, sensitive data can be anonymized using Salesforce Data Mask.

Hotfixes

A hotfix addresses an urgent issue impacting day-to-day business. It can be developed in a Developer sandbox and tested in a Partial Copy or Full sandbox.

Staging

Staging refers to validating the release prior to its deployment in the production environment. A full sandbox can be utilized for staging.



Sandbox Strategies

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Sandbox Types

There are **four different sandbox types** used for specific use cases.



Developer

Developer sandboxes are ideal for individual developers working on separate project streams.



Developer Pro

Developer Pro sandboxes can handle more development and quality assurance tasks and for integration testing or user training.



Partial Copy

Partial Copy sandboxes are suitable for user acceptance testing, integration testing, and training sessions.



Full

A Full sandbox is a full replica of production that can be used for staging, performance testing, load testing, and user acceptance testing.

Project Streams Management

Dedicated sandboxes can be utilized when there are **multiple** project streams.

ISOLATED DEVELOPMENT

Developer or **Developer Pro**

sandboxes can be assigned to each project team to prevent overlap and ensure isolated development efforts.



SOURCE CONTROL

Source-driven development and **version control** (with tools like Salesforce DX) can be used to merge development work from various streams for integrated testing in a **Partial Copy** or **Full Sandbox**.

Training Requirements

Special sandbox considerations are applicable when **user training** is required.

REALISTIC DATASETS

A **Partial Copy** or **Full** sandbox can be utilized for training to provide realistic datasets without impacting production data. It can be regularly refreshed to align with current business processes.



ANONYMIZATION

Sensitive data can be anonymized to comply with privacy standards, ensuring training environments are secure and up-to-date. **Salesforce Data Mask** can be utilized.

Staging

Staging refers to **validating the release** prior to its deployment in the live environment.

FINAL VALIDATION

Final validation can be conducted in a **Full sandbox** that simulates the production environment. This step is critical to **identify and mitigate any last-minute issues**.



REGULAR REFRESHES

Regular Full sandbox refreshes should be scheduled to ensure that the staging environment closely reflects the production setup for accurate testing.

Hotfix Development and Deployment

A hotfix is a simple change that **addresses an urgent issue** impacting day-to-day business.

RAPID FIXES

A **Developer sandbox** can be reserved for hotfix development to allow for rapid fixes to critical issues without disturbing the main development and release cycle.



HOTFIX TESTING

Hotfixes can be tested in a **Partial Copy** or **Full sandbox** before they are deployed to production to ensure that they don't introduce new issues.



Sandbox Refresh and Data Management

An appropriate **sandbox refresh strategy** should be utilized for different **release cycles**.

SANDBOX REFRESH

The sandbox refresh schedule should align with **major and minor release cycles** and the **project requirements**, ensuring that environments are reset and ready for new development work post-release.



DATA MASKING

A data masking strategy can be implemented for **training and testing environments** to **protect sensitive information** while maintaining the utility of real-world data scenarios.

Sandbox Preview Considerations

A preview sandbox provides **early access** to features in a **new Salesforce release** in advance, allowing **testing of configurations before the production upgrade**.

A **non-preview sandbox** can be refreshed **before the cut-off date** (the day before the preview starts) to ensure that they are **upgraded to the next major release**. It moves the sandbox to a **preview instance**.



If a **preview sandbox** is refreshed **after the cut-off date**, it is moved to a **non-preview instance** and reverts to the current release. If a **non-preview sandbox** is refreshed after the date, it remains on a **non-preview instance**.



The **Sandbox Preview Guide** can be used to determine if each of the sandboxes is on a preview or non-preview instance and what to do to either move to the next release or stay on the current release.



Business Scenario

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Business Scenario

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Technology Solutions is preparing for multiple Salesforce updates aimed at enhancing user interfaces, automating administrative tasks, and integrating third-party analytics tools. The development teams are working on several projects, including the development of new features, customization of existing applications, and critical bug fixes. Additionally, the company plans to roll out training for end users to familiarize them with the updates. The company's Salesforce architect must analyze various business requirements and recommend sandbox strategies for specific release plans. These strategies should accommodate aspects such as parallel development, staging environment, planned training sessions, and rapid deployment of hotfixes. These activities must be orchestrated seamlessly, ensuring that all updates are delivered efficiently and effectively without compromising the platform's integrity or user experience.

Requirements & Solutions

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Requirement 1



SCENARIO

A development team works on four types of releases: daily, minor, major, and urgent. It has finished working on a major project and is about to begin its release using a deployment train consisting of several sandboxes, which are on preview and non-preview instances. The project manager is concerned about the impact of the upcoming Salesforce release. The team also needs to work on urgent fixes for bugs found in production. Furthermore, a user has submitted an urgent request for a new report. The architect must recommend suitable sandbox strategies that align with these releases.



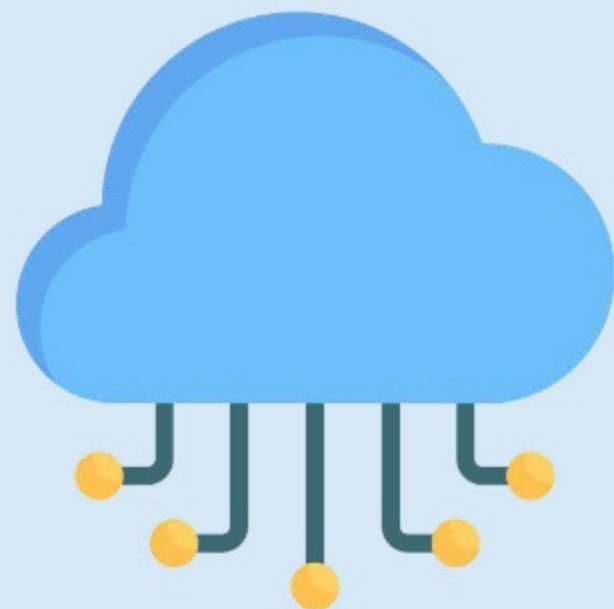
Solution 1 (Part 1)



SOLUTION

For the release of the major project, all **non-preview sandboxes** should be **refreshed before the cut-off date** to ensure that they are upgraded to the new release. This is to ensure that new features are tested and any potential issues with the project are identified in relation to the upcoming Salesforce release.

A **full sandbox** can be utilized for the urgent analysis and fixing of bugs found in production. Before any deployment in production, the **same process** must be performed in the full sandbox to identify and address potential issues before they affect the production environment. The sandbox should be **refreshed after the deployment** of each hotfix in production.

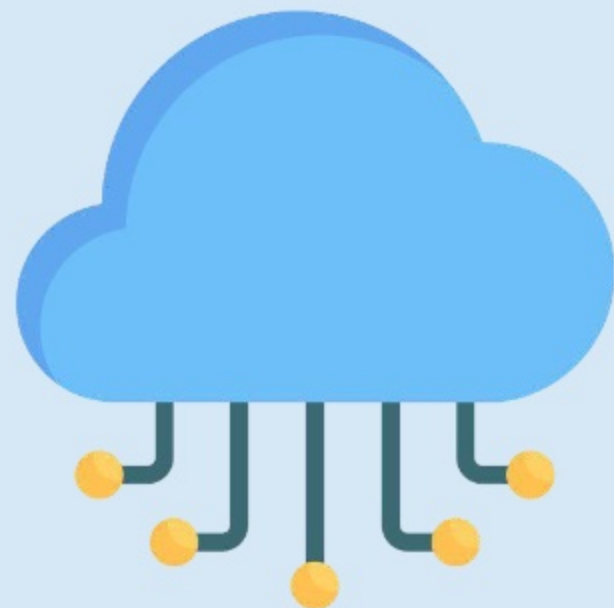


Solution 1 (Part 2)



SOLUTION

The **daily release process** can be utilized to create the report directly in a **full sandbox** and then deploy it to production. The daily release process is typically designed for quick changes that need to be deployed rapidly to address immediate needs or fix minor issues. Creating the report in a full sandbox first would allow testing and validation in an environment that mirrors production.



Requirement 2 (Part 1)



SCENARIO

The European division of the company wants to implement a release strategy with major releases every four weeks and minor releases every week. Major releases should go through development, system integration testing (SIT), user acceptance testing (UAT), and training. Minor releases should go through development and user acceptance testing (UAT). The architect must suggest a suitable sandbox strategy for UAT.

Also, the division is planning for a new Service Cloud implementation project for a large support center, which will require extensive training and change management.



Requirement 2 (Part 2)



SCENARIO

The implementation has dependencies on the existing Sales Cloud implementation. A suitable sandbox strategy that utilizes an appropriate release plan is required for the implementation. The architect must also provide considerations related to the use of a staging environment for the development lifecycle.

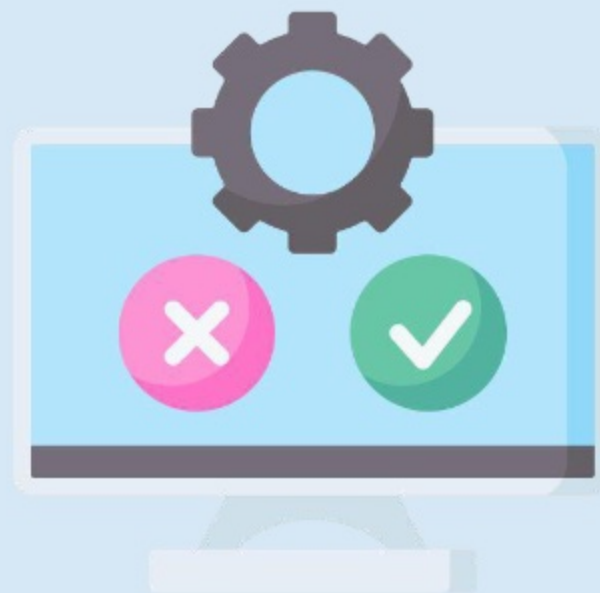


Solution 2



SOLUTION

Considering the required release timelines, **minor releases** should use a **partial copy sandbox** and **major releases** should use a **full sandbox** for user acceptance testing (UAT). For the Service Cloud implementation project, the **major release process** should be utilized. **User acceptance testing (UAT)** and **extensive training** should be performed in a **full sandbox** before deployment to production. A separate full sandbox can be used as the **staging environment** for the release. A staging sandbox is typically a **full replica** of production when it is created or refreshed.



Learn More

- [!\[\]\(6302aad5aed157b291fddf37b4870784_img.jpg\) Sandbox Types and Templates](#)
- [!\[\]\(a9ca2c237943a6d0a9f22252f295b6f3_img.jpg\) What are Preview and Non-Preview Sandboxes?](#)
- [!\[\]\(9a01a64e0b4ff865df7d32ee7991fe8b_img.jpg\) Salesforce Sandbox Preview Instructions](#)
- [!\[\]\(6aefe9a3d997eb8b55c40ecd5fa7053f_img.jpg\) Salesforce Sandbox Preview Guide](#)
- [!\[\]\(baa8f8ba8c970db55300f5bb45bb3460_img.jpg\) Sandbox Management Best Practices](#)
- [!\[\]\(a6e28495607b2299466d3d5d3193848c_img.jpg\) Change and Release Management](#)

